

Deal 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 6 5
♥ 7 3
♦ T 9 3
♣ A K J 6 2

13
8 7
12

♠ K Q J 4 2

♥ K 5

♦ A 5 2

♣ 7 5 3



♠ A 7 3

♥ Q J T 8 2

♦ K 8 6

♣ Q 4

♠ T 9

♥ A 9 6 4

♦ Q J 7 4

♣ T 9 8

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 1

NORTH's 2

♦

bid is New Minor Forcing.

NORTH chose

♦

s rather than ♣s simply

because the

♦

s were stronger.

West

North

East

South

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

2 ♦

Pass

1NT

Pass

4 ♠

2 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

Deal 2

South Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 7 3
♥ T 7 3
♦ J 8 6 4
♣ A K 9

8
10 6
16

♠ J 8 4
♥ K Q 8 4
♦ Q 5 2
♣ 7 6 3



♠ K 5
♥ A J 9 6 2
♦ A K
♣ J 8 5 2

♠ A T 9 6 2
♥ 5
♦ T 9 7 3
♣ Q T 4

West	North	East	South
			1 ♥
Pass	2 ♥	Pass	3 ♣
Pass	3 ♥		
All Pass			
3 ♥ by South			

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 2

SOUTH is unlikely to win 10 tricks if NORTH has three ♣ losers.

SOUTH's 3 ♣ bid is a Help Suit Game try.

With no help in ♣s and no ruffing values, NORTH's 8 points are

not enough to think of game, so NORTH signs off in 3



.

Deal 3

North Deals
None Vul

♠ T 9 5
♥ J 7 6 2
♦ A T 9
♣ Q T 8

13
7 6
14

♠ A J 7 6 2
♥ K T 9 4
♦ K Q 6
♣ 4



♠ K 8
♥ Q 8 5
♦ J 8 4
♣ A K J 7 3

♠ Q 4 3
♥ A 3
♦ 7 5 3 2
♣ 9 6 5 2

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♣
Pass	2 ♥	Pass	3 ♦
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by North			

s stopped so she bids 3NT.

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 3
SOUTH's 3

♦

bid is Fourth Suit Forcing and

does NOT show a

♦

stopper.

The bid asks NORTH to further describe her hand.

NORTH does not have a rebiddable suit, but does have

Deal 4

South Deals
None Vul

♠ A J T 3
♥ J 4
♦ J 8 6 5
♣ A 9 6

10
11 7
12

♠ Q 9 6 5 2
♥ 7 6 3
♦ A Q
♣ Q 8 4



♠ 8 7
♥ A Q 5
♦ K T 9 4 3
♣ K T 7

♠ K 4
♥ K T 9 8 2
♦ 7 2
♣ J 5 3 2

West	North	East	South
			1♦
Pass	1♠	Pass	1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2NT
All Pass			
2NT by South			



s.

But he does have



s stopped, so bids 2NT. North is not strong

enough to bid game so she passes.

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 4

NORTH cannot rebid the 5-card ♠ suit, cannot support SOUTH's



s,

and cannot bid Notrump without a



stopper.

So she bids 3♣, New Minor Forcing, asking SOUTH to describe his hand further.

SOUTH doesn't have three ♠s, nor does he have four

Deal 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J
♥ Q 9 8 2
♦ Q 8 5 2
♣ A Q 9 8

14
11 8
7

♠ A K T 6 2

♥ A 4 3

♦ K 9 6 4

♣ 7



♠ Q 5 4 3

♥ 7 5

♦ A J T 3

♣ 6 5 2

♠ 9 8 7

♥ K J T 6

♦ 7

♣ K J T 4 3

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 5

NORTH's 3

♦

bid is a Help Suit Game Try.

SOUTH has excellent help in

♦

s

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

Pass

2 ♠

Pass

3 ♦

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

so with 8 points he bids the game.

Deal 6

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 7
 ♥ K 8 6 5 3
 ♦ A T 6 5 2
 ♣ 5 4

14
 7 6
 13

♠ Q J 8 3

♥ A Q J 7

♦ J 9

♣ K T 2



♠ A T 5

♥ T 4

♦ K Q 7 4

♣ A 8 6 3

♠ K 9 6 4 2

♥ 9 2

♦ 8 3

♣ Q J 9 7

West

North

East

South

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

1 ♦

Pass

3NT

1NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 6

NORTH has no reason to consider New Minor Forcing with this hand.

SOUTH does not have four



s or he would have already supported, and

he does not have four ♠s or he would not have bid 1NT.

So NORTH should bid the Notrump game.

Deal 7

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ J T
 ♥ A 6 3
 ♦ Q J T 8 7 3
 ♣ 7 2

12
 8 7
 13

♠ A Q 9 7 2

♥ 8 5

♦ A 9 6

♣ Q T 4



♠ K 6 4

♥ K Q 9 7 4

♦ 4

♣ A J 6 5

♠ 8 5 3

♥ J T 2

♦ K 5 2

♣ K 9 8 3

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 7

NORTH might well bid 3NT at his second
 turn, and this may turn out to be the

final contract anyway.

But it doesn't hurt to bid 2

♦

(Fourth Suit Forcing) just to

see if SOUTH happens to have three ♠s. She
 does, so 4♠ becomes the better game.

West	North	East	South
			1 ♥
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♣
Pass	2 ♦	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			

Deal 8

South Deals
None Vul

♠ Q J 9 2
♥ A 6 5
♦ 8 6 2
♣ J 7 6

13
8 6
13

♠ A K 7 6 3
♥ K T 8 4
♦ K 4
♣ 5 2



♠ 8 5
♥ Q J 9 7
♦ A Q 9
♣ A 8 4 3

♠ T 4
♥ 3 2
♦ J T 7 5 3
♣ K Q T 9

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	1NT
Pass	2 ♦	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	4 ♥		
All Pass			
4 ♥ by South			

Change SOUTH's



9 to the ♠ 9 and the contract would be 4 ♠.

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 8

SOUTH isn't strong enough to make a Reverse bid of 2



at his second turn.

NORTH uses the 2



(NMF) bid to ask SOUTH for further description.

SOUTH should first show a 4-card



suit, and next show 3-card ♠ support.

Deal 9

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8 6 3
♥ A J 4 3 2
♦ A K
♣ 6 5 2

14
12 9
5

♠ A Q J T 7

♥ 7 6 5

♦ 3

♣ A K 8 4



♠ K 9 4 2

♥ 8

♦ 8 7 5 4 2

♣ Q 9 7

♠ 5

♥ K Q T 9

♦ Q J T 9 6

♣ J T 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

2 ♠

Pass

3 ♥

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 9

NORTH's 3



bid is a Help Suit Game Try.

SOUTH barely had enough strength to respond in the first place, but revaluing the hand,

(and particularly the singleton



), makes it worth a

raise to game.

Deal 10

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ 9 4 3
♥ Q T 8 2
♦ 9 5
♣ K Q 8 4

12
7 8
13

♠ K T
♥ A 9 7 5 4
♦ K Q 6 2
♣ 9 6



♠ A J 7 5
♥ K 6
♦ 8 7 4
♣ A J T 3

♠ Q 8 6 2
♥ J 3
♦ A J T 3
♣ 7 5 2

West	North	East	South
	1♥	Pass	1♠
Pass	2♦	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 10

SOUTH has no reason to consider Fourth Suit
Forcing with this hand.

NORTH does not have four ♠s or he would
have already supported.

So SOUTH should bid the Notrump game.

Deal 11

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 4
♥ K 5
♦ T 9 5 3 2
♣ K Q J 5 3

12
9 11
8

♠ A 7
♥ Q T 9 7 6
♦ Q 7
♣ A T 9 6

N
W E
S

♠ J 8 3
♥ A 8 3 2
♦ K 8 6 4
♣ 7 2

♠ K Q T 9 6 5 2
♥ J 4
♦ A J
♣ 8 4

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 11

NORTH should pass 2



. She is not strong enough to
try for game.

West

North

East

South

1 ♥

Pass

2 ♥

All Pass

2 ♥ by North

Deal 12

South Deals
None Vul

♠ 7
♥ 5 4 2
♦ A K J 7
♣ T 9 7 6 3

13
8 6
13

♠ K Q T 6 3
♥ K Q J 8
♦ 9 5
♣ Q 8



♠ 8 4
♥ A T 7
♦ Q T 6 4 3
♣ A K 2

♠ A J 9 5 2
♥ 9 6 3
♦ 8 2
♣ J 5 4

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	1NT
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 12

NORTH knows there should be game, but doesn't know whether it will be 4 ♠,

4



or 3NT. To find out which she uses NMF and

bids 2 ♣ at her second turn.

SOUTH does not have a 4-card



suit, nor does he have

three ♠s, but he does have ♣s stopped so he bids 2NT, which North raises to 3NT.

Deal 13

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 6 2
♥ A 7 6 2
♦ Q T 3
♣ 9 8 6

16
6 10
8

♠ A J
♥ K Q J 8 4
♦ A 5
♣ J 5 4 2



♠ K 5 3
♥ T 9 5 3
♦ 9 8 6 4
♣ K Q

♠ Q T 9 7 4
♥ -
♦ K J 7 2
♣ A T 7 3

West

Pass

All Pass

4♥ by North

North

1♥

3♣

East

Pass

Pass

South

2♥

4♥

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 13

NORTH cannot see a game unless SOUTH has help in ♣s so she makes a Help Suit Game Try.

SOUTH has 8 points and the doubleton ♣ K Q so he bids the game.

Deal 14

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 4
 ♥ K 9 6 5 2
 ♦ 7 6
 ♣ 9 8 2

13
 8 5
 14

♠ 9 8 5
 ♥ J 7 4
 ♦ K Q T 3
 ♣ A K 5



♠ A J T
 ♥ A Q T 3
 ♦ 9 4
 ♣ Q J 6 4

♠ 7 6 3 2
 ♥ 8
 ♦ A J 8 5 2
 ♣ T 7 3

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	1 ♦	Pass	1 ♥
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 14

NORTH has a perfect hand on which to use
 Fourth Suit Forcing. If South can stop

♠s, then 3NT would be a great contract.

There is one problem - if NORTH bids 1 ♠ at
 her second turn it is NOT considered

FSF, so she must jump to 2 ♠.

SOUTH, win a fine ♠ stopper, bids 3NT.

Deal 15

North Deals
None Vul

♠ A J 6
♥ 9 5 4 2
♦ K 5 4 2
♣ 7 4

13
8 7
12

♠ Q 7 5
♥ J T 7 6
♦ A 8
♣ K Q J 3



♠ K 8 4 3 2
♥ K Q 8 3
♦ 7 3
♣ A 5

♠ T 9
♥ A
♦ Q J T 9 6
♣ T 9 8 6 2

West	North	East	South
	1♣	Pass	1♠
Pass	1NT	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			
4♥ by North			

s is

first priority.

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 15
SOUTH's 2



bid is a perfect example of NMF.

It provides NORTH with the opportunity to show either a 4-card



suit,

OR 3-card ♠ support.

In this hand NORTH actually has both. When that happens, showing the

Deal 16

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 6 5
 ♥ T 9 4 3
 ♦ 8 4
 ♣ K Q 7 3

13
 9 6
 12

♠ Q T 8 3

♥ A K 6 5

♦ T

♣ A 9 8 4



♠ K J 9 7

♥ 8 7

♦ A K J 6 2

♣ T 2

♠ 4 2

♥ Q J 2

♦ Q 9 7 5 3

♣ J 6 5

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 16

SOUTH's 1♠ bid is definitely forcing, but it is not FSF. In this one instance, all

bids at the one level, the ♠ bid shows a real suit.

So NORTH shows the 4-card support and SOUTH bids game.

West	North	East	South
	1♣	Pass	1♦
Pass	1♥	Pass	1♠
Pass	2♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by South			

Deal 17

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 5 3 2
 ♥ J 4
 ♦ K 4 2
 ♣ Q T 3

14
 9 10
 7

♠ A 6 4
 ♥ A K 9 7 2
 ♦ 7
 ♣ K 8 6 5



♠ 9 7
 ♥ Q 6 5 3
 ♦ T 8 3
 ♣ A J 7 2

♠ Q J T
 ♥ T 8
 ♦ A Q J 9 6 5
 ♣ 9 4

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	3 ♣	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			
4 ♥ by North			

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 17

NORTH could make a Help Suit Game Try in either ♠s or ♣s.

But she doesn't need the ♠ help as much as she does in ♣s, so she chooses ♣s.

SOUTH doesn't have a strong hand but has excellent help in ♣s

so he bids the game.

Deal 18

North Deals
N-S Vul

♠ A 8 2
♥ 7 3 2
♦ Q 6 2
♣ T 9 7 6

14
6 7
13

♠ K J T 5
♥ T 9 6
♦ K 7
♣ A Q J 3



♠ Q 6
♥ K J 8 5
♦ A 9 8 5 4
♣ K 8

♠ 9 7 4 3
♥ A Q 4
♦ J T 3
♣ 5 4 2

West	North	East	South
	1♣	Pass	1♦
Pass	1♠	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			



suit and bid 3NT.

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 18
Could SOUTH bid 2



, (FSF), even though she actually has the suit?

Perhaps, but there is no reason to do so.
NORTH does not have four



s

or he would have mentioned them before
bidding ♠s.

SOUTH should ignore the

Deal 19

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 9
♥ A 4 3 2
♦ Q 7 5 2
♣ Q T 3

12
9 6
13

♠ A K T 6 3

♥ K Q 9 8 5

♦ 6 3

♣ 5



♠ Q 5 4

♥ 7 6

♦ A K 9 8

♣ A 8 7 4

♠ 8 7 2

♥ J T

♦ J T 4

♣ K J 9 6 2

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 19

NORTH cannot bid 2



at his second turn; that would be

Fourth Suit Forcing and wouldn't show the



suit at all.

West

North

East

South

With a game-forcing two-suiter he jumps to 3

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

1 ♦



Pass

3 ♥

Pass

2 ♣

All Pass

4 ♠

instead.

4 ♠ by North

SOUTH recognizes that NORTH must hold five ♠s and bids the ♠ game.

Deal 20

South Deals
None Vul

♠ A J 4 3 2
♥ T 9
♦ 8 5 3
♣ Q 7 5

11
7 10
12

♠ K 7 6
♥ K J 8 7 3
♦ A 9 4
♣ 9 2



♠ Q 8 5
♥ A 5
♦ K Q J 6 2
♣ 6 4 3

♠ T 9
♥ Q 6 4 2
♦ T 7
♣ A K J T 8

West	North	East	South
			1♦
Pass	1♥	Pass	1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♦
All Pass			
2♦ by South			

suit.

NORTH has nowhere to go, so passes.

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 20

NORTH bids 2♣ as New Minor Forcing,
hoping SOUTH has three

♥

s.

SOUTH does not have three

♥

s and he has no other bid to make that

will describe his hand any better. He cannot
bid Notrump again without a ♣ stopper.

So SOUTH rebids the 5-card

Deal 21

North Deals

None Vul

♠ T 9 5
♥ T 8 6 2
♦ 5 3
♣ A K J 4

12
8 7
13

♠ 8 4
♥ A K 9 4 3
♦ A J 9 6
♣ 7 5



♠ A Q J 6 3
♥ Q J 5
♦ K 4
♣ T 9 2

♠ K 7 2
♥ 7
♦ Q T 8 7 2
♣ Q 8 6 3

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	2 ♦	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			
4 ♥ by North			

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 21

SOUTH should not use Fourth Suit Forcing to see if NORTH holds three ♠s because

that information is irrelevant.

SOUTH already knows there is an 8-card



fit and enough

points to be in game so he bids it.

Deal 22

South Deals
None Vul

♠ T 7 5 2
♥ K Q 9
♦ Q J 5 4
♣ J 2

7
9 8
16

♠ Q 9 3
♥ 7 6 4 2
♦ K T 8 2
♣ Q 5



♠ A K J 8 6
♥ J 5 3
♦ 3
♣ A K 6 3

♠ 4
♥ A T 8
♦ A 9 7 6
♣ T 9 8 7 4

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	3 ♥
Pass	3 ♠		
All Pass			
3 ♠ by South			

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 22

SOUTH thinks there might be game if NORTH
can help with the three



losers. So he bids 3



as a Help Suit Game Try.

NORTH cannot provide any help at all, so
quickly signs off in 3 ♠ which SOUTH passes.

Deal 23

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q T 3
♥ T 8 7
♦ T 8
♣ A K 9 7 2

10
9 8
13

♠ A J 8 6 2

♥ Q 9 3

♦ K 7 4

♣ 8 5



♠ K 9 5

♥ K J 2

♦ A 9 6 3

♣ Q 6 4

♠ 7 4

♥ A 6 5 4

♦ Q J 5 2

♣ J T 3

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 23

NORTH bids 2♣ as New Minor Forcing,
hoping SOUTH will show three ♠s.

SOUTH does show three ♠s, but also shows a
minimum hand so North passes.

West	North	East	South
			1♦
Pass	1♠	Pass	1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♠
All Pass			
2♠ by North			

Deal 24

South Deals
None Vul

♠ J 4 3 2
♥ 8 3
♦ T 6 3
♣ A T 9 2

13
5 9
13

♠ K T 7
♥ A K 6 5 2
♦ J 9 8
♣ Q 5



♠ A 9 5
♥ T 4
♦ K Q 7 4
♣ K J 6 3

♠ Q 8 6
♥ Q J 9 7
♦ A 5 2
♣ 8 7 4

West	North	East	South
			1♦
Pass	1♥	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			

s but confirms a ♠ honor by

bidding 2NT, so NORTH bids the game in Notrump.

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 24

NORTH wants to be in game but doesn't know which one.

If SOUTH holds three



s she would prefer 4



,

otherwise she would try 3NT. NORTH bids 2♠, Fourth Suit Forcing.

SOUTH denies three

